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Why Hindus Should Worry

The majority community has good reason to fear a Hindu Rashtra because in any theocracy the State appropriates the official religion

Illustration by NILANJAN DAS



The story of civilisations is all about the rise and fall of communities. But how do you characterise the rise and fall of a civilisation? Can what is happening in India be really termed as the finest hour of Hindu civilisation? Should we assume that the new wave of communal frenzy, the stinking environment of hate and the rise of the so-called fringe to the mainstream mean that Muslims are passing through their worst times and that it is the end of the road for them?

RSS (Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh) chief Mohan Bhagwat repeatedly says that the happiest Muslims in the world are in India. Is the extreme right bent upon proving him wrong? Can anybody be happy being intimidated, demonised and maligned daily? Can one be happy when one's autonomy to eat, dress, marry, and now even worship, is undermined? Can one be happy hearing a seer declare that he has begun a *dharmayuddh* (holy war) against Muslims and their killing will start from eastern UP? What joy can there be in being subjected to open threats of rape against one's mother and daughters on a daily basis?

But are Hindus happy? In the recently released World Happiness Index report (2021) of the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network pursuant to the General Assembly Resolution of 2011, India ranks a low 136th among 149 countries. In our neighbourhood, China is at 84, Bangladesh 101 and Pakistan